AA-B-605A
May 23, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. AA-B-00605(GSA-FSS)
May 5, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BOX, FILING, STEEL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers steel filing boxes with hinged lids.

1.2 Classification. The filing boxes shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Size 1 - For 3 x 5 inch cards
Size 2 - For 4 x 6 inch cards
Size 3 - For 5 x 8 inch cards

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

QQ-S-698 - Steel, Sheet and Strip, Low-Carbon.
TT-C-490 - Cleaning Methods and Pretreatment of Ferrous Surfaces for Organic Coatings.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes: Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141 - Paint, Varnish, Lacquer, and Related Material; Methods of Inspection, Sampling and Testing.
Fed. Std. No. 187 - Identification of Pressed Bends, Forms, Seams, and Joints, (Sheet Metal).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The base, lid, and hinge shall be made of cold, or hot rolled commercial quality sheet steel conforming to QQ-S-698.

3.2 Design. The filing box shall consist of a base, and lid. The lid shall be attached to the base by a hinge(s). The upper front and sides of the base section shall have a ledge not less than 3/32 inch wide to serve as a stop for the lid. The lid shall land evenly and squarely on the ledge, and shall be flush with the base. The lid shall constitute not less than 1 inch of the height dimensions of the filing box.

3.3 Construction.

3.3.1 Base and lid. The base and lid shall be made of sheet steel conforming to 3.1, with a minimum thickness of 0.0209 inch. The base and lid shall be of seam weld, or lap and spot weld construction. There shall be sufficient number of spot welds on the seams to ensure a strong box. Bends, forms, seams, and joints shall conform to Fed. Std. No. 187. The underside of the bottom of the base shall have four protective shoes (feet), or four round embossed protuberances. The inside and outside of the box shall be devoid of sharp edges or corners.

3.3.2 Hinge. The hinge(s) shall be the butt stop type, and shall be made of steel conforming to 3.1 with a minimum thickness of 0.032 inch. Each box shall have a single hinge (piano type), or two or more hinges. The total length of the hinge of a box with one hinge shall be not less than 2/3 of the width of the box. The total length of the hinges of a box with two or more hinges shall be not less than 1/3 of the width of the box. The hinge(s) shall be securely spot welded to the base and lid, and there shall be no opening greater than 1/16 inch between the base and lid, when box is closed. The lid shall open a minimum of 90 degrees and not more than 125 degrees.

3.4 Dimensions. The inside dimensions of the filing boxes shall be as shown in table I.

TABLE I. Minimum inside dimension of boxes (in inches)

Size	Height	Width	Depth
1 - 3 x 5	3-1/2	5-1/16	6
2 - 4 x 6	4-1/2	6-1/16	5
3 - 5 x 8	5-1/2	8-1/16	5

3.5 Finish. All metal surfaces shall be cleaned and pretreated for final finishing in accordance with TT-C-490. Enamel of a color specified in the Solicitation of Offers shall be used for the final coating of the surface (see 6.2). The minimum total dry finishing film coating shall be not less than 1.0 mil, when tested as specified in 4.4 and 4.4.1. The finish shall be smooth and uniform, without runs, wrinkles, grit, or foreign matters, lumpy areas, areas of thin or no film, or separation of color.

3.6 Identification marking. Unless otherwise specified, each filing box shall be legibly and permanently marked with the name or trademark of the manufacturer. When specified, additional specified marking shall be included in the marking.

3.7 Workmanship. All filing boxes shall be free from defects and imperfection which may affect appearance or serviceability, or may constitute a personal hazard to the user. The filing box shall be free from sharp edges, burrs, dents, cracks, chips, blisters, rust and faulty construction.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Size of lot. All filing boxes of the same size presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of examination.

4.2.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.2.3 Sampling for visual and dimensional examination. Random sample filing boxes shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one filing box. The filing box shall be examined for defects listed in table II. The Inspection Level shall be S-4, and the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery and selected at random just prior to closing operations. Shipping containers fully prepared shall be examined for closure defects. The Inspection Level shall be S-4, and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.2.5 Sampling for coating test. Two sample units shall be taken from each lot and tested as specified in 4.4 and 4.4.1.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined for defects listed in table II. Any sample having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Classification for defects

Examine	Defects
Material	Not as specified (see 3.1).
Design	Not as specified (see 3.2).
Construction	Not as specified (see 3.3, 3.3.1 and 3.3.2).
Dimensions	Not as specified (see 3.4 and table I).
Finish	Not as specified (see 3.5).
Identification Marking	Not as specified (see 3.6).
Workmanship	Not in accordance with 3.7.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be examined for defects listed in table III, to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with.

TABLE III. Classification of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; improper size, location sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate applicant of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling, or distortion of container.
Contents (exterior container)	Number per container is more or less than required; Net weight exceeds requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4 Test for coating. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.5 shall be subjected to the test specified in 4.4.1. Failure to meet the thickness requirement of the finish shall be cause for rejection of the entire lot.

4.4.1 Thickness test. The thickness of the coating of the filing boxes shall be determined to the nearest 0.0001 inch by Test Method 6183 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141, for compliance with 3.5.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Each box shall be unit packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-2.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. When specified (see 6.2) boxes of like description, unit packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be further packaged in quantities as specified (see 6.2) in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure of boxes shall conform to Method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Unit packaging. Each box shall be individually packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, PPP-B-665 or to PPP-B-676. Closure of boxes shall be in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.1.2.2 Intermediate packaging. Six boxes of like description, unit packaged as specified in 5.1.2.1 shall be further packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, PPP-B-665 or to PPP-B-676. Closure of boxes shall be in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The boxes shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturers standard practice, providing that this will insure protection for the boxes during shipment and provides for safe delivery to their destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Boxes of like description packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in quantities as specified (see 6.2) in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. Close, water proof seal and strap each container in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Two intermediate packages (12 boxes) of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure of containers shall be in accordance with Method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. Boxes of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1.3 shall be packed in containers that will assure safe arrival at destination in compliance with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or purchase order, all marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. All marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. All marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The filing boxes are intended to be used as filing boxes for the maintenance of index cards or forms printed on card stock.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size of filing box required (see 1.2, 1.2.1, 3.3 and table I).
(c) Color of filing box required (see 3.5).
(d) Inspection responsibility, if other than specified herein (see 4.1).
(e) Applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Marking required (see 5.3).

NO OFFICIAL DOD INTEREST HAS BEEN REGISTERED

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

User activity:

Army - GL

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.